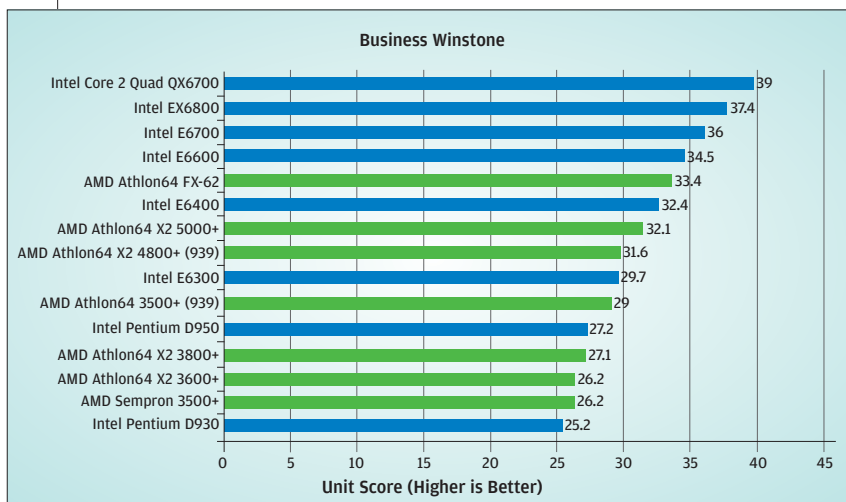
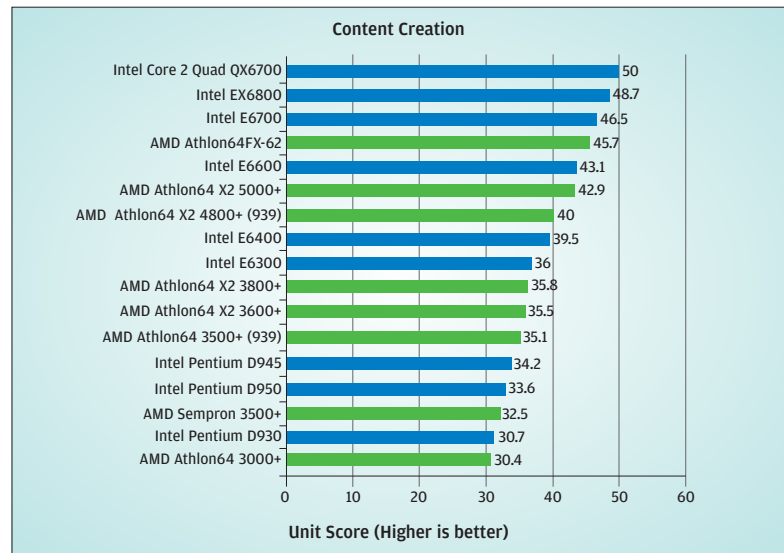


ZD Content Creation 2004

In this content-driven benchmark, the QX6700 takes the lead over the EX6800. The performance gap isn't significant, but the increment is proportional to the performance on offer. AMD's FX-62 is right among the big boys, as expected in real-world scenarios. The E6600 and AMD Athlon64 X2 5000+, for the first time, are on an even playing field. The E6300, despite running at a measly 1.86 GHz, stays ahead of AMD Athlon64 X2 3800+. The Pentium D series is starting to show its age and are left behind in the company of the Sempron and Athlon64 3000+.



ZD Business Winstone 2004

The graph is nearly identical to what we saw in the content creation benchmark, save some minor changes. The Intel processors were on top, displacing the AMD FX-62 to fifth position. Sadly enough, the AM2 processors from AMD hardly live up to the competition and are thrashed even by the E6300.

Conclusion

As opposed to last year, when AMD ruled the gaming and multimedia arena, the tide has now turned to Intel's favour. Processors based on the Core architecture are running riot and are brutally beating the processors from AMD. The addition of DDR2 support doesn't seem to have worked in AMD's favour. If you are interested in building a gaming or multimedia machine, the Core 2 Duo-based processors are your best bet. While the EX6800 is way too expensive, the E6600 and E6700 are the processors to grab.

3D Rendering Benchmarks

Cinebench 9.2

3D rendering is the most demanding of applications and puts a heavy load on the processor. In fact, while rendering, the PC becomes useless for any other work. Cinebench 9.2 takes full advantage of multi-processor environments.

The Quad Core QX6700 simply outstripped all other processors in this test. While the near-double score speaks for the performance of the four cores, it also offers a glimpse of what multi-core processors can actually deliver in the right ecosystem. While this multi-CPU test takes around 40 seconds to complete on any other processor, the quad core finished it in just 12 seconds by dividing the work load into four equal parts. The rest of the processors scale proportionally to the performance on offer as seen in the graph.

